

MEDIEVAL HISTORY



MODULE - 2

PALA DYNASTY



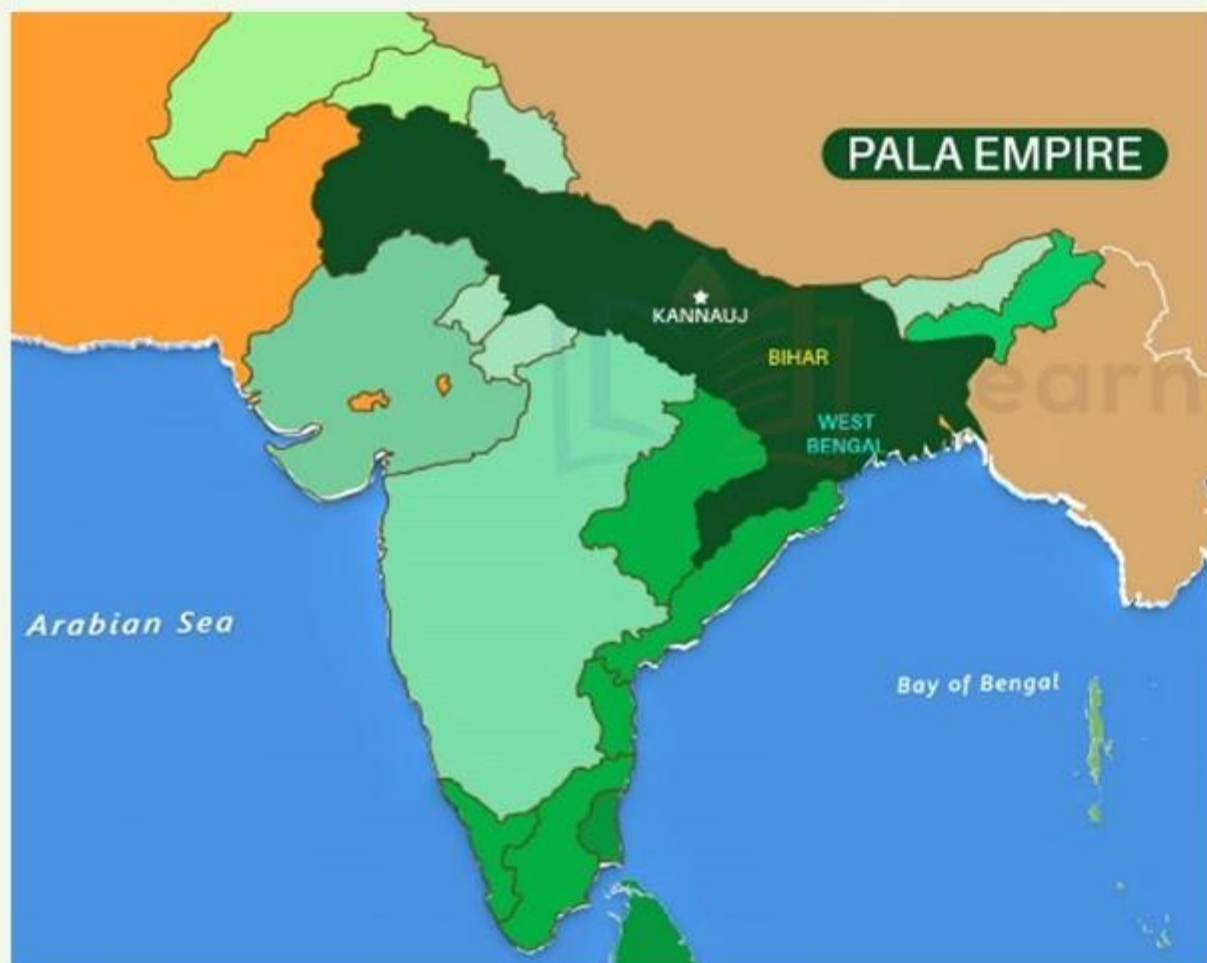


PALA DYNASTY

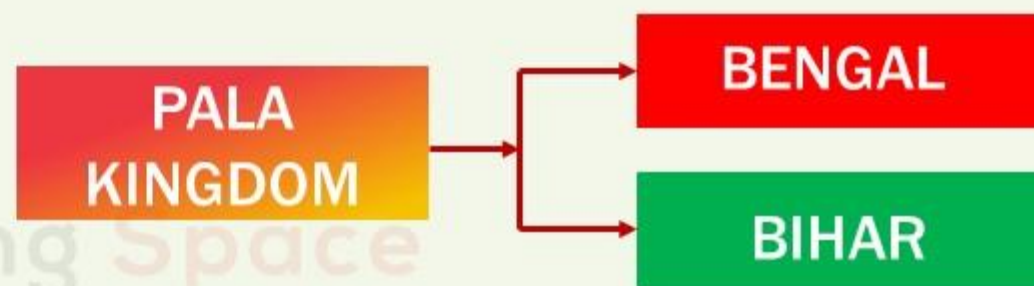


PALA DYNASTY

INTRODUCTION



8th CENTURY – PROTECTOR (IN PRAKRIT)



...Included major cities

- ✓ PATALIPUTRA
- ✓ VIKRAMPUTRA
- ✓ RAMWATI
- ✓ MUNGER
- ✓ TAMRALIPTI
- ✓ JAGGADALA

PALA EMPIRE

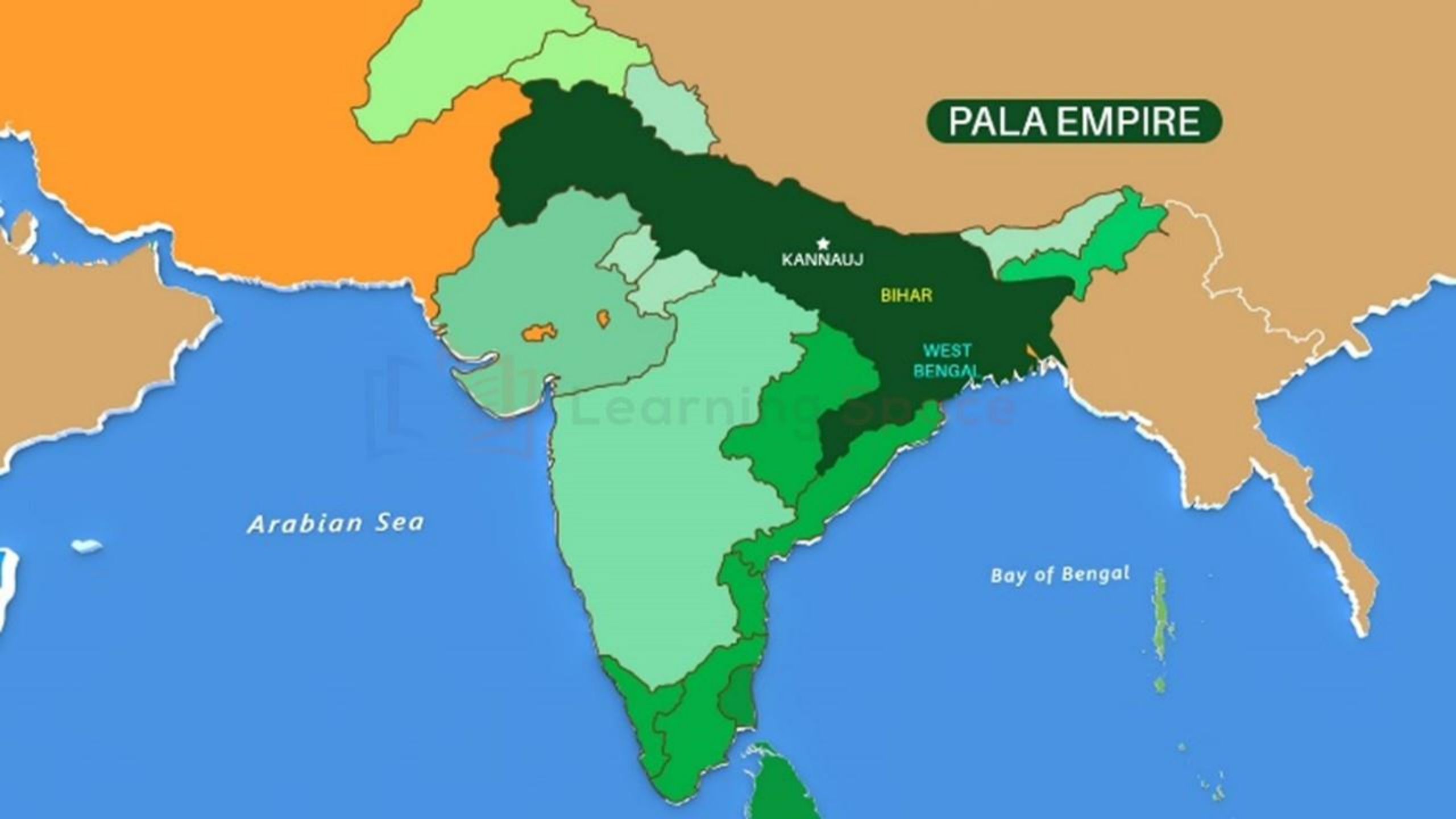
KANNAUJ

BIHAR

WEST
BENGAL

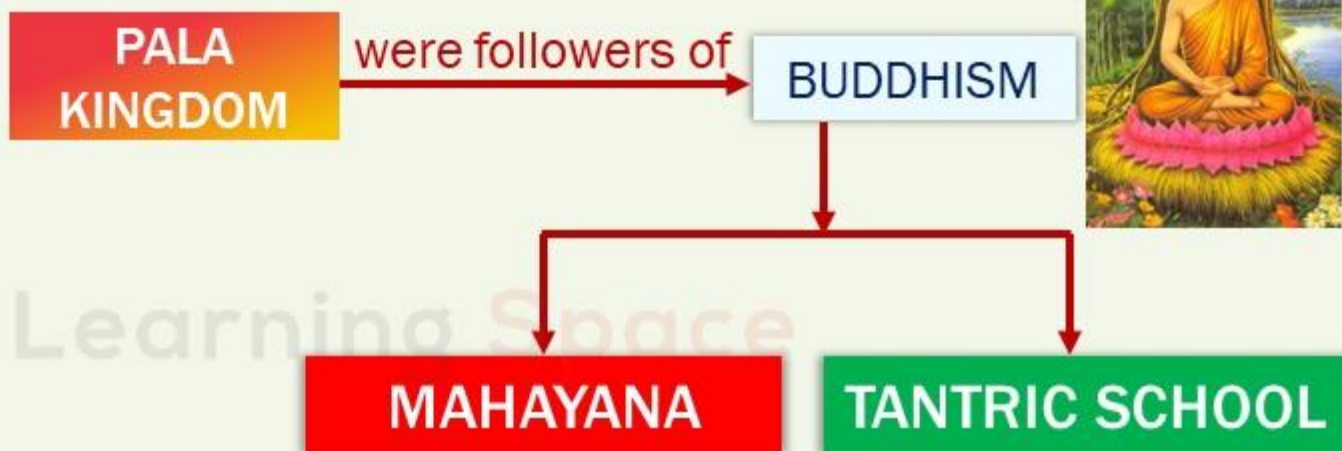
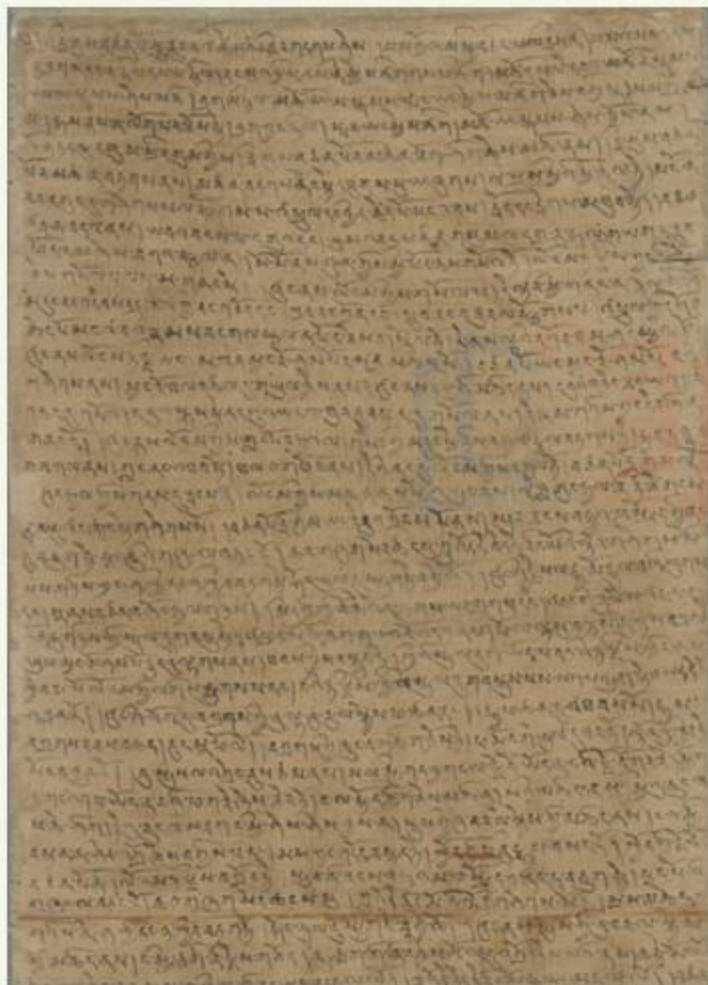
Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal



PALA DYNASTY

PALAS OF BENGAL



- Pala legacy is still reflected in Tibetan Buddhism and **TIBETAN CHRONICLES** forms important source of Palas History.
- Palas promoted Buddhism greatly via construction of **MONASTRIES (VIHARAS)**

PALA DYNASTY

GOPALA

Accord to the KHALIMPUR copper plate inscription of Dharmapala, Pala Dynasty was founded by Gopala.

GOPALA

→ Ardent Buddhist

→ Built famous Monastery at ODANTAPURI



GOPALA

[750 AD–770 AD]

DHARMAPALA

[770 AD–810 AD]

DEVAPALA

[810 AD–850 AD]

MAHIPALA I

[977 AD–1027 AD]

RAMPALA

[1072 AD–1126]

PALA DYNASTY

DHARMAPALA



- Succeeded GOPALA - I
- Known as the ABLEST of the Pala rulers

DHARMAPALA



- Initially – was defeated by Rashtrakuta King Dhruva
- Later – Conquered large parts of Northern India

GOPALA
[750 AD–770 AD]

DHARMAPALA
[770 AD–810 AD]

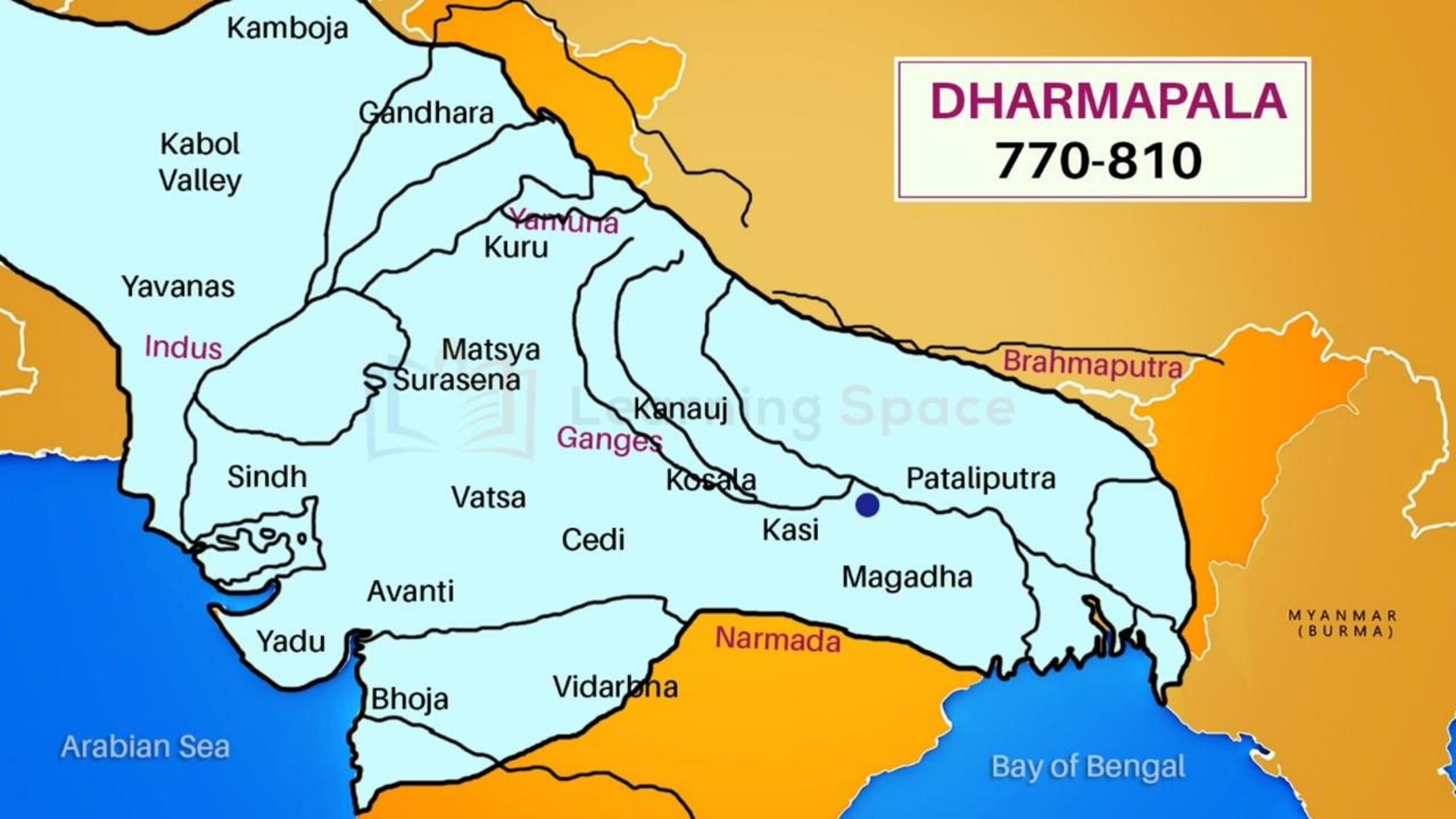
DEVAPALA
[810 AD–850 AD]

MAHIPALA I
[977 AD–1027 AD]

RAMPALA
[1072 AD–1126]

DHARMAPALA

770-810



PALA DYNASTY

DHARMAPALA

- Dharmapala held a durbar at Kannauj which was attended mainly by **vassal chiefs**.
- Dharmapala then installed a puppet ruler *Chakra-yudha* on the throne.

Hence,
Bihar
Bengal

was under the direct
rule of Dharmapala

KANNAUJ – *functioned as a dependency on Pala Kingdom*

Rulers of

- ✓ Punjab
- ✓ Western hill states
- ✓ Rajputana
- ✓ Malwa
- ✓ Berar

Accepted the sovereignty
of Dharmapala.

GOPALA

[750 AD–770 AD]

DHARMAPALA

[770 AD–810 AD]

DEVAPALA

[810 AD–850 AD]

MAHIPALA I

[977 AD–1027 AD]

RAMPALA

[1072 AD–1126]

PALA DYNASTY

DHARMAPALA

Founded **VIKRAMSHILA MONASTERY** near Bhagalpur in Bihar



Attracted students from all over **India - Tibet**

- Buddhist scholar Dipankar (called Atisa) was associated with this monastery.
- Founded SOMAPURI MONASTERY near Paharpur Bihar.
- Granted 200 villages to Nalanda University
- Buddhist scholar SANTARAKSHITA was an abbot of NALANDA, belonged to Dharmapala's region.



GOPALA

[750 AD–770 AD]

DHARMAPALA

[770 AD–810 AD]

DEVAPALA

[810 AD–850 AD]

MAHIPALA I

[977 AD–1027 AD]

RAMPALA

[1072 AD–1126]

PALA DYNASTY

DEVAPALA

Took forward the legacy of his father and extended the empire to include:

- Pragjyotishpura / Kamarupa (Assam)
- Parts of Orissa (Utkala)
- Modern Nepal

His territories included

[Vast region from KAMBOJ in North] to [VINDHYAS in the South]

His inscriptions proclaim victories over

- Hunas
- Gujaras
- Dravidas

King of SUMATRA had also sent an ambassador to his court

GOPALA

[750 AD–770 AD]

DHARMAPALA

[770 AD–810 AD]

DEVAPALA

[810 AD–850 AD]

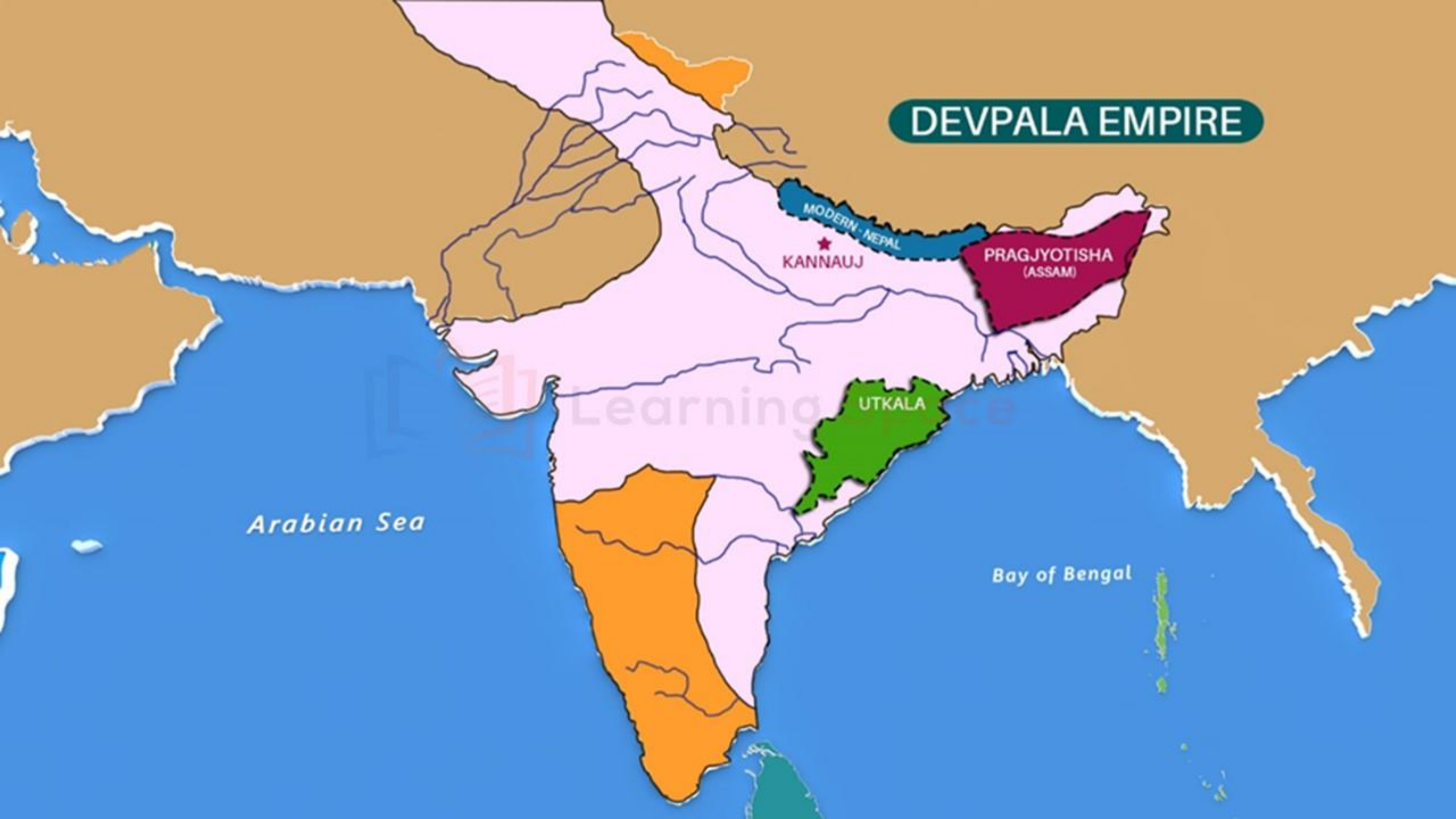
MAHIPALA I

[977 AD–1027 AD]

RAMPALA

[1072 AD–1126]

DEVPALA EMPIRE



KANNAUJ

MODERN - NEPAL

PRAGJYOTISHA
(ASSAM)

UTKALA

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

DEVAPALA
810-850



Kamboja

Khasa

Huna

Kannauj

Gujarat

Malawa

Pragjyoti

Laata

Utkala

Arabian Sea

Karnataka

Bay of Bengal

Pandya

PALA DYNASTY

DEVAPALA

- Devapala was a great patron of Buddhism. He granted 5 villages to the monastery at **Nalanda** and appointed VIRADEVA as the head of Nalanda Monastery.
- His court poet was a Buddhist scholar VAJRA – DATTA who is the author of Lokesvara-sataka



SULAIMAN – Arab Merchant

- He is believed to have visited India during mid of 9th century, during Devapala's reign

DEATH OF DEVAPALA

- Marked the beginning of decline of Pala dynasty. Though his successors tried to control the dominions, late 9th century saw Pala's defeat against PRATI HARAS and RASHTRAKUTAS for the control of Kannauj
- Further, Subordinate rulers of Assam and Orissa assumed Independence.

GOPALA

[750 AD–770 AD]

DHARMAPALA

[770 AD–810 AD]

DEVAPALA

[810 AD–850 AD]

MAHIPALA I

[977 AD–1027 AD]

RAMPALA

[1072 AD–1126]

PALA DYNASTY

MAHIPALA I

- He tried to restore the might of Pala Kingdom in late 10th century
- He defended Pala Kingdom against **Chola invasions** in Bengal and Bihar
- But, he was subsequently defeated by **RAJENDRA CHOLA**



- He ordered restoration and repair of various sacred structures at Bodh Gaya, Sarnath and Nalanda and also enlarged the architecture at SOMAPURA MAHAVIHARA

GOPALA
[750 AD–770 AD]

DHARMAPALA
[770 AD–810 AD]

DEVAPALA
[810 AD–850 AD]

MAHIPALA I
[977 AD–1027 AD]

RAMPALA
[1072 AD–1126]

PALA DYNASTY

RAMPALA



GOPALA
[750 AD–770 AD]

DHARMAPALA
[770 AD–810 AD]

DEVAPALA
[810 AD–850 AD]

MAHIPALA I
[977 AD–1027 AD]

RAMPALA
[1072 AD–1126]

- Ramapala was the last strong Pala ruler.
- He tried to revive Pala Kingdom by gaining control of KAMARUPA and KALINGA in the 11th century

PALA DYNASTY

DECLINE OF PALA DYNASTY



- Pala Empire considerably got weakened by the 11th century.
- Many of its areas were witnessing Rebellion.
- Further,
 - ✓ Pala's power was destroyed by the SENA DYNASTY under VIJAYSENA
 - ✓ Pala Empire got dethroned in the 12th century ending the reign of the last major Buddhist imperial power in the subcontinent.

PALA DYNASTY

POINTS TO REMEMBER

PALA PERIOD

One of the Golden Eras in the history of Bengal

- Brought stability in Bengal after centuries of Civil wars between divisions.
- Outstanding work in Art and Architecture
 - Build **Grand Temples** and Monasteries
E.g.: SOMAPUTRA MAHAVIRA
 - **Patronized great universities** of NALANDA and VIKRAMASHILA
 - **Proto Bengali** language was developed which laid the basics of Bengali language.
- Pala Empire built strong relations with
 - SRI-VIJAYA EMPIRE
 - TIBETAN EMPIRE
 - ARAB CALIPHATE

POINTS TO REMEMBER



- **ISLAM** first appeared in Bengal during Pala Rule, as a result of increased trade between Bengal and Middle East.

CHARYAPADA

- First literacy work in Proto Bengali
- Collection of Mystic Buddhist poems from Tantric traditions
- Writers of Charyapada are called **MAHA-SIDDHAS**

PALA DYNASTY

POINTS TO REMEMBER

Pala Empire was divided into several subdivisions for better administration



POINTS TO REMEMBER



AGRICULTURE

- Paddy cultivation had become chief source of economy in Bengal
- Agro based industry thrived during Palas region
- Silk industry too thrived and was an important exported good



TEXTILE INDUSTRY thrived under Palas with cotton textile becoming the principle industry.

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